DM ONLY — Library answer & running sheet

Statue	Evidence	Relic
1 Victoria	Black ink is ground into her fingertips and thumbs.	Book
2 Alexi	Dried, flaking mud is caked on his boots and coat hem.	Scythe
3 Teresa	Dark crimson stains her palms and the skin under her fingernails.	Dagger
4 Valerius	He smells of salt and brine. Tiny barnacles cling to his shoulder plates.	Spear
5 Borislav	Black soot smears his jaw, knuckles and forearms.	Hammer
6 Barov	Nothing. No stain, no grime, not even dust. He gleams as if polished this morning.	Crown

Setup & inspection

Place six statues and relic tokens; raise Barov on a small box or book. Put the gargoyle above the table. Hide slips, inscriptions, full titles, Spectre and crest.

Investigation DC 13: Fred +4, Griffin +5. Success earns the detail slip. Failure invites a new approach next turn; never lock out the clue. Barov needs no roll on a close inspection (Mage Hand, climb, or close study after Clue 3).

Character hooks

Fred: once this station, Let's Split Up gives both partners advantage inspecting different statues. Griffin: invisible, so immune to the gargoyle's sight-based shriek; Mage Hand reaches Barov without a climb. Otherwise climb Athletics DC 12.

Misplacements

Every wrong placement drops ALL placed relics back to the table. On the second and later wrong placements, gargoyle shrieks: DC 12 Wisdom or 1d6 psychic to visible characters. Griffin is never targeted.

Taboo swap: dagger to Barov or crown to Teresa releases Spectre: AC 12, HP 14, +4 to hit, 1d6 necrotic. Warn neutrally before every crown or dagger placement, whether the proposed match is right or wrong. Handling and inspection are safe. An offering to a statue counts as placement; moving a token around the table does not.

DM ONLY — Coaching & emergency clues

Opening

Six stone ancestors wait with empty hands. Six relics lie under a rumpled velvet runner. A stone gargoyle watches. Barov stands on a taller plinth. Do not name professions or announce stains before inspection.

2–3 minutes

“That velvet runner is lumpy. Anyone curious?” Lifting the runner reveals the reading-table inscription; by 3:00 let it slide away if they need help.

5–6 minutes

“Your sheet says you love splitting up. Anything there that fits?” For Griffin: “Barov’s hands are way up there. Anything that reaches?” Give the earned detail slips, not the item answers.

8–9 minutes

Reveal the plinth plate. “Look closely at what isn’t there.” If they have not found it by 9:00, the plate cracks free automatically.

Emergency — only after taboo swap or stuck at 11:00

The ghost librarian whispers: “Give the book to the ink, the scythe to the mud, the hammer to the soot, the spear to the brine, the crown to the spotless one, and the dagger to the blood!”

At 11:00 say only the pairs still missing. At 13:00 give the full line if needed. Open the gate by 15:00.

Protect deduction

Do not confirm guesses until a token is placed. Reward creative inspection. Keep the same warning for correct and incorrect crown/dagger choices. Cap unrelated combat or semantic debates at about a minute, then redirect toward evidence.

Source: Stations/Station_1_Library_Crown_and_Dagger.md. The placement-trigger rule above follows the explicit Failure Consequences section.